TRAVEL & TELEPHONE REIMBURSEMENT POLICY

(Revised wef 1st September 2025)

The organization extends the facility of reimbursement of travel and telephone expenses incurred for the purpose of conducting daily work outside of its project and site offices and outstation travel. It is assumed that all personnel will use the economical and least time consuming mode of public transport to conduct said work. All local conveyance, travel and telephone expenses will be reimbursed at actuals (or subject to limits defined below) after submission of duly approved expense vouchers with requisite supporting documents.

LOCAL CONVEYANCE

All below personnel who need to travel outdoors for official work will be reimbursed as follows:

1. **For all Coordinators and equivalent level and Managers/Associate Director/ Director/ Executive Director/ Chief Executive Officer**: Bus, I/II class train, auto-rickshaw / taxi or Ola/Uber services or other private hired vehicles

Expenses incurred during the month should be noted down in the "Conveyance Expenses Claim" Form on a daily basis and submitted after supervisor's approval to the Finance Department at the end of the monthly attendance cycle, for which the cut off date is 25th of every month.

Local conveyance will be paid as per following guidelines:

1. Home to reporting office/project site and vice versa: No conveyance will be paid as this is considered as your official workplace.
2. Home to non-reporting office/project sites: Can be claimed
3. Reporting office/project site to other offices/sites/meetings/any other official work: Can be claimed

MOBILE PHONE USAGE

Personnel may use their personal mobiles for official use. Depending on program/domain budgets outlined and available for the expense, amounts are reimbursed at actuals subject to limits defined below. Personnel need to submit duly approved expense vouchers with supporting documents to the Finance department by the end of the monthly attendance cycle, for which the cut off date is 25th of the month.

FIXED CONVEYANCE AND MOBILE ALLOWANCE FOR OFFICER LEVEL AND BELOW

Local conveyance and telephone expenses will be paid as a fixed allowance per month (included in the 'Other Allowances' component of the salary). *Addendum w.e.f from 1st July 2015.* This has been revised to Rs.3700 p.m. wef 1st Sep 2025.

No vouchers/ supporting documents need to be submitted for reimbursements, and no additional expenses will be reimbursed towards conveyance and mobile usage.

CHECKING AND APPROVAL OF CONVEYANCE AND MOBILE EXPENSES

All conveyance and mobile expense vouchers have to be checked and approved by authorized personnel. Approval for any exceptions exceeding limits will have to be justified and signed off by authorized personnel

(to be mentioned on the "Conveyance Expenses Claim" form). The excess claim would be allowed subject to availability of budgets.

CONVEYANCE AND MOBILE EXPENSES FOR CONSULTANTS

Normally, remuneration to Consultants is inclusive of the conveyance component. In case any consultant is expected to conduct extensive field visits to deliver outcomes, the conveyance and mobile expenses may be reimbursed as per limits defined at the Coordinator/Manager/Director levels. However, these limits are to be stipulated in the consultancy contract itself. Cut-off date for consultants would be 25th of each month

LOCAL CONVEYANCE AND MOBILE REIMBURSEMENT SLABS

Personnel Cadre	**Monthly Conveyance Expenses**	**Monthly Mobile Expenses**
Community Organizers, Assistants, Data Entry Operators and all Officers	A fixed amount has been added into the 'Other Allowances' component of the CTC wef 1st July 2015. No further reimbursements will be paid. Revised to Rs.3700 p.m. wef 1st Sep 2025.	
Coordinator level	Up to Rs. 2300	Up to Rs. 500
Associate Director/Manager level	Up to Rs. 2750	Up to Rs. 750
Director level	Up to Rs. 3850	Up to Rs. 1000
Executive Director/CEO level	Up to Rs. 5500	Up to Rs. 2000

All figures subject to periodic review and change at the discretion of the management.

GUIDELINES FOR LOCAL CONVEYANCE AND TELEPHONE REIMBURSEMENT (FOR COORDINATOR/MANAGER UPWARDS) AND FOR CONSULTANTS TO WHOM REIMBURSEMENT IS ALLOWED AS PER CONTRACT:

- Local Conveyance and telephone expenses incurred for the purpose of conducting daily work will be reimbursed at actuals/ceiling whichever is less - details should be clearly stated in the requisite form.

- No local conveyance to be claimed from home to reporting office and vice versa. Information on Conveyance and Telephone slabs will be regularly communicated via email. Any excess claims will be settled at the sole discretion of the management.

- **Conveyance expenses incurred during the month, should be noted down in the "Conveyance Expenses Claim" Form on a daily basis and submitted after supervisor's approval to the Finance Department. The cut-off date is 25th of every month and to be submitted to finance by every month end, except for the month of March, where the cut-off date is 31st March. In case of any project ending in a particular month in the middle of the financial year, it would be till the end date of the project for that month.**

- Conveyance and telephone reimbursements are subject to actual expenses, and the limits mentioned are the "upper limits" and if staff have spent lesser amount, they are eligible to claim only the actual expenses incurred.

- In case of conveyance, please mention exact amounts (rounding off to the nearest rupee) in the "Conveyance Expenses Claim" form. Mention full details as per claim format with details of the origin and destination with exact location for verification. Detailed address is not required to be updated. Also mention to and fro travel in separate lines instead of combining the two in one line. Please note that while no supporting documents are required for claiming reimbursement of local conveyance, all details of travel, mode, date, time and purpose should be clearly stated in the claim form. Only in case of use of Ola/ Uber or other private hired vehicles, attach printout of the receipt/invoice with the claim form. Wherever staff have shared transport with other staff, mention the names of the respective staff also in the "mode of transport" column. Please refer to the sample filled up claim form for reference and refer to the guidelines mentioned in the last column, which could be used as a reference while filling up your claim form. Mention specific reason at the bottom of the claim form, in case claim is more than the limit allowed for the month, which should be countersigned by your supervisor specifying reason for the excess claim and also mention "Total Conveyance amount approved Rs.XXXX as an exception".

- In case of **"prepaid"** mobile connections, only recharge done through the respective mobile service operator's store (for eg. Vodafone Idea / Airtel store) etc., with their official receipt would be accepted. In case of payments made through electronic modes/ payment vallets (like google pay/ amazonpay/ paytm/ freecharge/ mobiquick etc.), please attach the relevant payment statement reflecting the transaction (date/ amount etc.)

- Any kachha receipt (standard printed receipt book which are generally available in stationery shops) with rubber stamp of vendor **will not be accepted.**

- Reimbursement would be allowed for use of own vehicle as below :
  a. For Two Wheeler : Rs.6.50 per km travelled (on submission of detailed log of such travel)
  b. For Four Wheeler : Rs.12.50 per km travelled (on submission of detailed log of such travel)

OUTSTATION TRAVEL

The organization has laid down guidelines for personnel travelling outstation for official work. Expenses incurred on outstation travel for official work will be reimbursed as follows, subject to availability of budgets:

- **Below Officer level:** IInd Class Sleeper/AC Chair Car train/luxury bus
- **Officer/Coordinator/Manager level**: AC Chair Car/3AC/2AC train/luxury bus /Air*
- **Associate Director/Director level**: AC Chair Car/3AC/2AC train/luxury bus/Air*
- If personnel avail higher mode of travel, they will have to pay the differential fare
- Train/air tickets/boarding passes will have to be produced as supporting documents while claiming expenses for such travel
- Personnel are expected to individually manage their own bookings and submit expense vouchers with due supporting documents to the Finance department for payment
- **Travel Report to be attached as part of the supporting document**

** Air travel (discounted/economy fares only) for long distances within and outside India and subject to availability of budgets*

ACCOMMODATION, FOOD AND CONVEYANCE ALLOWANCE FOR OUTSTATION TRAVEL

Expenses incurred for accommodation (twin-sharing, where possible) and meals for such outstation trips will be sanctioned as follows, subject to availability of budgets:

Location	**Accommodation (twin-sharing, where possible) & Food Expenses per day per person**	**Local Conveyance Expenses per day per person**
Tier I cities	Up to Rs. 6500 all inclusive	Up to Rs. 1200
Tier II Cities	Up to Rs. 5000 all inclusive	Up to Rs. 900
Smaller Towns	Up to Rs. 3600 all inclusive	Up to Rs. 600

All figures subject to periodic review and change at the discretion of the management

Refer the "Classification of Cities" table given at the end of the Policy.

All expenses can be claimed at actuals on presentation of supporting documents and subject to the maximum limits outlined above.

- If personnel choose to stay with relatives/friends during the course of outstation travel, they will not be eligible to claim accommodation expenses
- Any exceptions exceeding above mentioned limits to be justified and approved at Director level after cross verifying availability of budget with the Finance department
- Where program budgets do not allow for outstation travel, and such travel is deemed necessary to achieve program goals, approval and sanction will be at management discretion on a case to case basis

Classification of Cities for Outstation Travel

HRA classification	City
Tier I Cities	Ahmedabad, Bengaluru, Chennai, Delhi, Hyderabad, Kolkata , Mumbai, and Pune
Tier II Cities	Agra, Ajmer, Aligarh, Amravati, Amritsar, Asansol, Aurangabad, Bareilly, Belgaum, Bhavnagar, Bhiwandi, Bhopal, Bhubaneswar, Bikaner, Bilaspur, Bokaro Steel City, Chandigarh, Coimbatore, Cuttack, Dehradun, Dhanbad, Bhilai, Durgapur, Erode, Faridabad, Firozabad, Ghaziabad, Goa, Gorakhpur, Gulbarga, Guntur, Gwalior, Gurgaon, Guwahati, Hamirpur, Hubli–Dharwad, Indore, Jabalpur, Jaipur, Jalandhar, Jammu, Jamnagar, Jamshedpur, Jhansi, Jodhpur, Kakinada, Kannur, Kanpur, Kochi, Kolhapur, Kollam, Kozhikode, Kurnool, Ludhiana, Lucknow, Madurai, Malappuram, Mathura, Mangalore, Meerut, Moradabad, Mysore, Nagpur, Nanded, Nashik, Nellore, Noida, Patna, Pondicherry, Purulia, Prayagraj, Raipur, Rajkot, Rajahmundry, Ranchi, Rourkela, Salem, Sangli, Shimla, Siliguri, Solapur, Srinagar, Surat, Thiruvananthapuram, Thrissur, Tiruchirappalli, Tiruppur, Ujjain, Bijapur, Vadodara, Varanasi, Vasai-Virar City, Vijayawada, Visakhapatnam, Vellore and Warangal
Smaller Towns	All other cities and villages

Source : Classification of Indian Cities (Wikipedia)